

Course 18: Professional Presence & Opportunity Building

Lesson 3: Showcase Your Work

What You're Doing Today

You already did the hard part back in Course 16 — you built real projects and wrote case studies about them. Today you make that work *visible*. You'll pick your 2–3 strongest projects and add them to your LinkedIn Featured section (or your portfolio page's Projects section, if you're using the portfolio-first path). Then you'll run the Portfolio Review Checklist on your own profile/page as a final polish before anyone else sees it.

Why This Matters

A recruiter, mentor, or program reviewer looking at your profile decides whether to keep reading in the first few seconds. If your best work is buried, invisible, or unexplained, it doesn't count — it might as well not exist. A **showcase entry** is how you make sure your best work is the first thing a stranger sees, and that they understand it without needing to ask you a single question.

How to Present a Project as a Showcase Entry

Every showcase entry has exactly three parts. Skipping any one of them weakens the whole entry.

Part	What it does	How to write it
Title	Names the project and what kind of thing it is	Short — project name plus a 2–4 word type tag, e.g. "(App Concept)" or "(Website Build)"
Result-focused description	Tells a stranger what happened because of this project, not just what you did	1–2 sentences. Include a real number or outcome if you have one (users, testers, time saved, a problem solved)
Link	Sends the viewer to real proof	A working, publicly viewable link to your case study doc, deck, image, or live project

Result-focused vs. task-focused — the key difference:

- Task-focused (weak): *"I made a budgeting app using Canva for my class project."*
- Result-focused (strong): *"Designed a budgeting app prototype that 8 beta testers used for two weeks; 6 said it helped them track spending more consistently."*

The second version answers "so what?" The first one doesn't.

Worked Example

Fictional student: Jordan R., 16, completed a Course 16 case study called "MoodBoard: A Daily Mood Tracker for Teens" — a mobile app mockup, tested with 10 classmates over one week.

Showcase entry:

- **Title:** MoodBoard — Daily Mood Tracker (App Concept)
- **Description:** Designed and mocked up a mood-tracking app aimed at teens; tested with 10 classmates over one week, with 8 saying it helped them notice mood patterns they hadn't before.
- **Link:** [https://docs.google.com/\[Jordan's shared case study link\]](https://docs.google.com/[Jordan's shared case study link])

Notice: the title is short and specific, the description has a real number and a real outcome, and the link points straight at evidence — not just a claim.

Step-by-Step Activity

1. **Open your Course 16 case study/project docs.** Reread them and rank your projects — which 2–3 have the clearest outcome or result attached?
2. **Draft your showcase entries on the Worksheet** for this lesson (title, description, link) before you touch your live profile. Drafting first means you won't publish a weak entry by accident.
3. **Check your link's sharing settings.** In Google Docs or Canva, set sharing to "Anyone with the link can view," then test the link in a private/incognito browser window to confirm a stranger could actually open it.
4. **Add the entry to your profile/page:** - *LinkedIn (16+):* Add profile section → Recommended → Add featured → Add a link → paste your case study link → edit the title and description fields to match your worksheet draft → Save. - *Portfolio-first (under 16):* Open your portfolio page → go to the Projects section → add a new entry block with title, description, and a "View Project" link → confirm the link is publicly viewable.
5. **View your profile/page as a stranger would.** On LinkedIn, use "View as public." On a portfolio page, open the link in an incognito window. Confirm the entry looks right and the link works.
6. **Run the Portfolio Review Checklist** ([Shared_Resources/Checklists/Portfolio_Review_Checklist.md](#)) against your whole profile/page. Make at least two edits based on what it turns up.

Key Terms

Term	Meaning
Featured section	The part of a LinkedIn profile built to highlight a small number of hand-picked posts, links, or media — not a full archive of everything you've done
Showcase (entry)	A single title + result-focused description + link, presenting one project as proof of a skill or outcome
Result-focused description	A description that states what changed or who was affected because of the project, rather than only listing the steps taken to build it

Knowledge Checks

1. What are the three required parts of a showcase entry?
 2. Rewrite this task-focused sentence into a result-focused one: *"I built a website in Google Docs for my final project."*
 3. True or False: The Featured section should include every project you've ever completed, so viewers see your full range.
 4. Why is checking a link in an incognito/private window an important step before publishing a showcase entry?
 5. Name one difference between the portfolio-first path and the LinkedIn path for adding a showcase entry.
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Reflection Prompts

1. Which of your Course 16 projects did you choose to feature, and what made it stand out from your other work?
 2. What is one edit the Portfolio Review Checklist made you notice that you wouldn't have caught on your own?
 3. If a stranger looked at your profile/page for 30 seconds, what do you want them to walk away thinking about you?
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Submission Instructions

Submit the following to your instructor by the end of class (or before the next session, per your instructor's deadline):

1. A link to your live LinkedIn profile (Featured section visible) or your portfolio page, showing at least one completed showcase entry.
2. Your completed Worksheet with all showcase-entry drafts and the final polish checklist section filled in.
3. One sentence naming the two edits you made after running the Portfolio Review Checklist.